SPEAK TO TRAVEL

Interview & Role-Play Question Bank

Companion to **File 1 (3-Month Program)**. Use these in Session B/C role-plays. **How to use:** pick 8–10 questions per round. Mix the order. Add follow-ups (→). Change speed and "personality" (friendly / neutral-fast / serious).

TEACHING MATERIAL

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TEACHER RULE

never give the student a memorized answer to repeat. Help them build **their own true answer**, short and clear. Real officers detect memorized speeches.

01 Airport immigration / passport control

OPENING

- Good morning. Passport, please.
- Where are you coming from? / Where did you fly in from?
- Is this your first time in the United States / in Canada / in the UK?

PURPOSE & STAY

- What's the purpose of your visit? / Business or pleasure?
- How long are you planning to stay? → Why that long?
- When are you going back? → Do you have a return ticket? Can I see it?
- Where are you staying? → What's the address? → Who's paying for the hotel?
- What are you going to do here? → Which cities are you visiting?

PEOPLE

- Are you traveling alone? → Who's that with you?
- Do you know anyone here? → What does your son/daughter do here? → Is he/she a citizen?
- Are you visiting family?

HOME TIES (PROOF YOU'LL GO BACK)

- What do you do in Brazil? → How long have you worked there?
- Are you retired? → What did you do before?
- Do you own a house in Brazil? → Do you have family there?

MONEY & CUSTOMS

How much money are you carrying? → Do you have a credit card?

Are you bringing any food, plants or animals? → Any meat, cheese, fruit?

Anything to declare? / Are you carrying more than $10,000?

What's in this bag?

CLOSING (LISTENING)

- *Look at the camera, please. / Put your right hand fingers here. Now your thumb.*
- *Enjoy your stay. / Welcome to the United States. / You're all set.*

OFFICER PERSONALITIES FOR PRACTICE

Friendly: smiles, slow, short interview (2 min).

Neutral-fast: no smile, very fast, 10 questions in 2 minutes.

Serious: follow-up on every answer, asks for documents, silence pauses (students must not fill the silence with nervous talk).

02 Visa interview (consulate) — practice version

Honest note for students: at US consulates in Brazil, the interview is often available in Portuguese — confirm when scheduling. Practice in English anyway: it builds confidence and prepares for the airport, where the conversation *will* be in English. Always tell the truth; consistency with the application form (DS-160 for the US) is what matters.

Why do you want to go to the United States?

Have you ever been to the US before? → When? How long did you stay?

Have you ever been refused a visa?

Who's going with you?

Who is paying for your trip?

What do you do for a living? → How much do you earn per month?

Are you married? → Does your spouse work? → Is he/she traveling with you?

Do you have children? → Where do they live?

Do you have relatives in the US? → What is their immigration status?

What will you do after your trip?

03 Hotel / accommodation

Hi, welcome. Checking in? → Can I have your name? → Can I see your ID and a credit card?

How many nights? / How many guests?

Would you like to upgrade to a room with a view for $30 more?

Breakfast is from 7 to 10 in the lobby restaurant. / Your room is on the 5th floor, the elevator is on your right.

Problem cards (student must call the front desk): no hot water · neighbors are noisy · room not clean · AC broken · wrong room type (they booked a double, got a single) · charged twice on the card.

04 Restaurant / café

Hi! How many? / Do you have a reservation?

Can I get you something to drink to start?

Are you ready to order, or do you need a few more minutes?

How would you like that cooked? / Which side would you like — fries, salad, or mashed potatoes?

Any allergies I should know about?

How is everything? / Can I get you anything else?

Are you still working on that? / Do you want a box for that?

Would you like to see the dessert menu?

Together or separate checks?

Problem cards: wrong dish · food is cold · there's a hair in the soup · the bill is wrong · you're vegetarian and there's meat in it.

05 Getting around

Where to? (taxi/Uber) → Which entrance? → Is here OK?

(Station) Where are you heading? → One-way or round trip? → That'll be $12.50.

(Car rental) Do you want full coverage insurance? / Will anyone else be driving? / Please return it with a full tank.

(Stranger) You look lost — can I help you?

Problem cards: the Uber didn't show up · wrong stop · the train is canceled · you got a parking ticket · flat tire.

06 Doctor / pharmacy / emergency

What seems to be the problem? / What brings you in today?	When did it start? → Is it getting better or worse?
On a scale from 1 to 10, how bad is the pain?	Are you taking any medication? → Any allergies?
Do you have travel insurance? → Can I see the card?	(Pharmacy) Do you have a prescription? / Take one pill twice a day with food.
(Police) What happened? → When and where? → Can you describe the person? → What was in the bag?	(Lost luggage) Can I see your baggage claim tag? → Can you describe the bag? → Where can we deliver it?

07 Small talk with strangers

So, where are you from? → Oh, Brazil! I've always wanted to go. What's it like?	Is this your first time here? → How do you like it so far?
What do you do? / Are you here on vacation?	How long are you in town for?
Have you tried the ___ here yet? You have to!	What's the best place to visit in Brazil? → Is it safe? → What's the food like?
Do you speak Spanish? *(expect this one — many think Brazilians speak Spanish)*	Are you a soccer fan?

08 Telling stories & opinions (Phase 3)

How was your trip? What was the best part? What was the worst part?	Tell me about your hometown. How has it changed?
What did you do for work? What did you like about it?	What's the most beautiful place you've ever been to?
If you could live anywhere, where would you live? Why?	Do you prefer traveling with a group or on your own?
What do you think about ___ (food in the US / big cities / technology)?	What's something you've always wanted to do but never did?

09 Bonus: job interview in English (for students who need it)

> Some students will want this. Add 2–4 sessions on top of the program if needed.

Tell me about yourself. *(the 60-second "My Story" — they've been building it since Week 1!)*

Why are you interested in this position?

What are your strengths? / What's one weakness?

Tell me about a time you solved a difficult problem. *(use the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result)*

Why did you leave your last job?

Where do you see yourself in five years?

Do you have any questions for us? *(they must always have 2!)*